

Thy palm some moment keeps. But now mine eyes,
Which I have darted at thee, hurt thee not;
Nor I am sure there is no force in eyes
That can do hurt.

SILVIUS

O dear Phoebe,

If ever—as that ever may be near—
You meet in some fresh cheek the power of fancy,
Then shall you know the wounds invisible
That love's keen arrows make.

PHOEBE

But till that time
Come not thou near me. And when that time comes,
Afflict me with thy mocks, pity me not,
As till that time I shall not pity thee.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

(Coming forward)

And why, I pray you? Who might be your mother,
That you insult, exult, and all at once,
Over the wretched? What though you have no beauty—
As, by my faith, I see no more in you
Than without candle may go dark to bed—
Must you be therefore proud and pitiless?
Why, what means this? Why do you look on me?
I see no more in you than in the ordinary
Of nature's sale-work.—'Od's my little life,
I think she means to tangle my eyes, too.—
No, faith, proud mistress, hope not after it.
'Tis not your inky brows, your black silk hair,
Your bugle eyeballs, nor your cheek of cream
That can entame my spirits to your worship.—
You foolish shepherd, wherefore do you follow her,
Like foggy south puffing with wind and rain?



SWEET PHOEBE, DO NOT SCORN ME



ENTER, UNOBSERVED, ROSALIND, CELIA, AND CORIN

Scene 5

Another part of the forest

(Enter SILVIUS and PHOEBE.)

SILVIUS

Sweet Phoebe, do not scorn me. Do not, Phoebe.
Say that you love me not, but say not so
In bitterness. The common executioner,
Whose heart th' accustomed sight of death makes hard,
Falls not the axe upon the humbled neck
But first begs pardon. Will you sterner be
Than he that dies and lives by bloody drops?

(Enter, unobserved, ROSALIND as GANYMEDE, CELIA as ALIENA, and CORIN.)

PHOEBE

I would not be thy executioner.
I fly thee, for I would not injure thee.
Thou tell'st me there is murder in mine eye.
'Tis pretty, sure, and very probable
That eyes, that are the frail'st and softest things,
Who shut their coward gates on atomies,
Should be called tyrants, butchers, murderers.
Now I do frown on thee with all my heart,
And if mine eyes can wound, now let them kill thee.
Now counterfeit to swoon; why, now fall down;
Or if thou canst not, O, for shame, for shame,
Lie not, to say mine eyes are murderers.
Now show the wound mine eye hath made in thee.
Scratch thee but with a pin, and there remains
Some scar of it. Lean upon a rush,
The cicatrice and capable impressure



PHOEBE

You are a thousand times a properer man
Than she a woman. 'Tis such fools as you
That makes the world full of ill-favoured children.
'Tis not her glass but you that flatters her,
And out of you she sees herself more proper
Than any of her lineaments can show her.—
But, mistress, know yourself. Down on your knees
And thank heaven, fasting, for a good man's love,
For I must tell you friendly in your ear,
Sell when you can; you are not for all markets.
Cry the man mercy, love him, take his offer.
Foul is most foul, being foul to be a scoffer.—
So take her to thee, shepherd. Fare you well.

PHOEBE

Sweet youth, I pray you chide a year together.
I had rather hear you chide than this man woo.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

He's fall'n in love with your foulness.

(*To SILVIUS*)

And she'll fall in love with my anger. If it be so, as fast as she answers
thee with frowning looks, I'll sauce her with bitter words.

(*To PHOEBE*)

Why look you so upon me?

PHOEBE

For no ill will I bear you.

ROSALIND AS GANYMEDE

I pray you, do not fall in love with me,
For I am falseer than vows made in wine.
Besides, I like you not. If you will know my house,
'Tis at the tuft of olives, here hard by.—
Will you go, sister?—Shepherd, ply her hard.—
Come, sister.—Shepherdess, look on him better,

CELIA

O, that's a brave man. He writes brave verses, speaks brave words, swears brave oaths, and breaks them bravely, quite traverse, athwart the heart of his lover, as a puny tilter that spurs his horse but on one side breaks his staff like a noble goose; but all's brave that youth mounts and folly guides.

(Enter CORIN.)

Who comes here?

CORIN

Mistress and master, you have oft inquired
After the shepherd that complained of love,
Who you saw sitting by me on the turf,
Praising the proud disdainful shepherdess
That was his mistress.

CELIA AS ALIENA

Well, and what of him?

CORIN

If you will see a pageant truly played
Between the pale complexion of true love
And the red glow of scorn and proud disdain,
Go hence a little, and I shall conduct you
If you will mark it.

ROSALIND

*[Aside to CELIA] O come, let us remove.
The sight of lovers feedeth those in love.*

(As GANYMEDE, to CORIN)

Bring us to this sight, and you shall say
I'll prove a busy actor in their play.

(Exeunt omnes.)



I HAD RATHER HEAR YOU CHIDE THAN THIS MAN WOO

CELLA

He hath bought a pair of cast lips of Diana. A nun of winter's sisterhood kisses not more religiously. The very ice of chastity is in them.

ROSALIND

But why did he swear he would come this morning, and comes not?

CELLA

Nay, certainly, there is no truth in him.

ROSALIND

Do you think so?

CELLA

Yes, I think he is not a pickpurse nor a horse-stealer, but for his verity in love, I do think him as concave as a covered goblet or a worm-eaten nut.

ROSALIND

Not true in love?

CELLA

Yes, when he is in, but I think he is not in.

ROSALIND

You have heard him swear downright he was.

CELLA

'Was' is not 'is.' Besides, the oath of a lover is no stronger than the word of a tapster. They are both the confinner of false reckonings. He attends here in the forest on the Duke your father.

ROSALIND

I met the Duke yesterday and had much question with him. He asked me of what parentage I was. I told him, of as good as he. So he laughed and let me go. But what talk we of fathers when there is such a man as Orlando?

And be not proud. Though all the world could see,
None could be so abused in sight as he.—
Come, to our flock.

(*Exeunt ROSALIND, CELIA and CORIN.*)

PHOEBE

[*Aside*] Dead shepherd, now I find thy saw of night:
'Who ever loved that loved not at first sight?'

SILVIUS

Sweet Phoebe—

PHOEBE

Ha, what sayst thou, Silvius?

SILVIUS

Sweet Phoebe, pity me.

PHOEBE

Why, I am sorry for thee, gentle Silvius.

SILVIUS

Wherever sorrow is, relief would be.
If you do sorrow at my grief in love,
By giving love your sorrow and my grief
Were both extermined.

PHOEBE

Thou hast my love. Is not that neighbourly?

SILVIUS

I would have you.

PHOEBE

Why, that were covetousness.
Silvius, the time was that I hated thee;
And yet it is not that I bear thee love;
But since that thou canst talk of love so well,
Thy company, which erst was irksome to me,

I will endure, and I'll employ thee too.
But do not look for further recompense
Than thine own gladness that thou art employed.

SILVIUS

So holy and so perfect is my love,
And I in such a poverty of grace,
That I shall think it a most plenteous crop
To glean the broken ears after the man
That the main harvest reaps. Loose now and then
A scattered smile, and that I'll live upon.

PHOEBE

Know'st thou the youth that spoke to me erewhile?

SILVIUS

Not very well, but I have met him oft,
And he hath bought the cottage and the bounds
That the old carlot once was master of.

PHOEBE

Think not I love him, though I ask for him.
'Tis but a peevish boy—yet he talks well—
But what care I for words? Yet words do well
When he that speaks them pleases those that hear.
It is a pretty youth—not very pretty—
But sure he's proud—and yet his pride becomes him.
He'll make a proper man. The best thing in him
Is his complexion; and faster than his tongue
Did make offence, his eye did heal it up.
He is not very tall—yet for his years he's tall.
His leg is but so-so—and yet 'tis well.
There was a pretty redness in his lip,
A little ripper and more lusty red
Than that mixed in his cheek: 'twas just the difference
Betwixt the constant red and mingled damask.
There be some women, Silvius, had they marked him

Scene 4

The Forest of Arden

(Enter ROSALIND, dressed as GANYMEDE, and CELIA, dressed as ALIENA)

ROSALIND

Never talk to me. I will weep.

CELIA

Do, I prithee, but yet have the grace to consider that tears do not
become a man.

ROSALIND

But have I not cause to weep?

CELIA

As good cause as one would desire. Therefore weep.

ROSALIND

His very hair is of the dissembling colour.

CELIA

Something browner than Judas's. Marry, his kisses are Judas's own
children.

ROSALIND

I' faith, his hair is of a good colour.

CELIA

An excellent colour. Your chestnut was ever the only colour.

ROSALIND

And his kissing is as full of sanctity as the touch of holy bread.



I'LL WRITE TO HIM A VERY TAUNTING LETTER

In parcels as I did, would have gone near
To fall in love with him; but for my part
I love him not nor hate him not; and yet
I have more cause to hate him than to love him.
For what had he to do to chide at me?
He said mine eyes were black and my hair black,
And now I am remembered, scorned at me.
I marvel why I answered not again.
But that's all one: omittance is no quittance.
I'll write to him a very taunting letter,
And thou shalt bear it. Wilt thou, Silvius?

SILVIUS

Phoebe, with all my heart.

PHOEBE

I'll write it straight.
The matter's in my head and in my heart.
I will be bitter with him and passing short.
Go with me, Silvius.

(*Exeunt omnes.*)

TOUCHSTONE
As the ox hath his bow, sir, the horse his curb, and the falcon her bells, so
man hath his desires; and as pigeons bill, so wellock would be nibbling.

JACQUES

And will you, being a man of your breeding, be married under a bush
like a beggar? Get you to church, and have a good priest that can tell you
what marriage is. This fellow will but join you together as they join
wainscot. Then one of you will prove a shrunk panel and, like green
timber, warp, warp.

TOUCHSTONE

I am not in the mind but I were better to be married of him than of
another, for he is not like to marry me well, and not being well married,
it will be a good excuse for me hereafter to leave my wife.

JACQUES

Go thou with me, and let me counsel thee.

TOUCHSTONE

Come, sweet Audrey. We must be married, or we must live in bawdry,—
Farewell, good Master Oliver, not

O sweet Oliver,

O brave Oliver,

Leave me not behind thee,

But

Wind away,

Begone, I say,

I will not to wedding with thee.

(*Exeunt AUDREY, TOUCHSTONE and JACQUES.*)

OLIVER MARTEXT

'Tis no matter. Ne'er a fantastical knave of them all shall flout me out of
my calling.

(*Exeunt omnes.*)